OAVS TGT · Current Affairs

Politics, Governance & Appointments

Built from the politics questions in your 5 previous-year papers

Coverage window: Jan 2025 – 28 Oct 2026

How this part is organised

Politics and appointments were **23 of 150** current-affairs questions (about 15%, or 4–5 per paper), the third-largest topic. They fall into five types: appointments and office-holders (12), judiciary (4), elections and ruling parties (3), ministers and chief ministers (2), and laws and amendments (2).

Section	Topic	Why it matters
1	Elections 2025–26 and new governments	Ruling-party and election-date questions in 2019; Telangana CM in 2024
2	Top constitutional and national office-holders	Most frequent type: appointments
3	Chief Ministers, Governors and Odisha	Odisha appeared twice in the 2019 paper
4	Parliament, laws and Constitution amendments	127th Amendment Bill in 2022; department renamed in 2019
5	Judiciary and the Election Commission	4 judiciary questions across papers
6	'Then and now' appointments tracker	Shows how PYQ answers have changed
7	Practice MCQs (25) and answer key	—

Reliability key. ✔ = checked against live web sources on 28 Oct 2026. ◆ = from my own knowledge, so cross-check once before the exam. Unmarked facts come from your PYQ keys.

What the PYQs tell us

Paper	Q	Topic asked	Type
Sci 2024	46	Anumula Revanth Reddy – second CM of Telangana (from 7 Dec 2023)	CM
Sci 2024	49	Union Minister of Parliamentary Affairs, Jan 2023 – Pralhad Joshi	Minister
Sci 2024	59	Chairman, National Monuments Authority (31 Dec 2022) – Prof. Kishor K. Basa	Appointment
Sci 2024	64	Col. Geeta Rana – first woman to lead a field workshop in eastern Ladakh	Appointment / firsts
Maths 2024	52	Deputy NSA (Jan 2023) – Pankaj Kumar Singh	Appointment
Maths 2024	57	Vice Chief of Air Staff (Feb 2023) – A. P. Singh	Appointment
Maths 2024	58	Director, National Health Authority (Jan 2023) – Praveen Sharma	Appointment
Maths 2024	63	16th Attorney General of India (Oct 2022) – R. Venkataramani	Appointment
Maths 2024	65	Vice-Chair, UN Panel of External Auditors – Girish Chandra Murmu	Appointment
Eng 2019	5	Prof. Najma Akhtar – field: education	Person
Eng 2019	7	Department renamed in Jan 2019 – Dept. of Industrial Policy and Promotion	Governance
Eng 2019	14	UPSC Chairman, Dec 2018 – Arvind Saxena	Appointment
Eng 2019	17	Ruling party of Odisha in 2018 – Biju Janata Dal	Ruling party
Eng 2019	20	State whose assembly election is held with Lok Sabha polls – Odisha	Elections
Eng 2019	28	Date of phase 2 of Lok Sabha Election 2019 – 18 April	Elections
Eng 2019	30	Chairman of DRDO – Dr G. Satheesh Reddy	Appointment
Eng 2022	6	Supreme Court committee on PM's Punjab security breach – five-member	Judiciary
Eng 2022	7	Vice-Chief of Army Staff (25 Jan 2022) – Lt Gen Manoj Pande	Appointment
Eng 2022	21	Constitution (127th Amendment) Bill 2021 – states' own OBC lists	Constitution
SS 2023	13	Judiciary statistics: 689 eSewa Kendras (31 Dec 2022)	Judiciary
SS 2023	20	Judgments by Constitution Benches, Jan 2023 – 3	Judiciary
SS 2023	26	Matching officials with designations (Mar 2023)	Appointment
SS 2023	30	Supreme Court Mobile App 2.0 (Dec 2022)	Judiciary

Patterns to exploit

- **About half the questions are 'who holds this post'.** The questions name a post and a month, then ask for the person. The 'then and now' table in Section 6 shows how the answers change over time.
- **Odisha showed up twice in 2019** (ruling party, simultaneous elections). Odisha-specific politics is a safe bet, so Section 3 has an Odisha box.
- **Judiciary questions are statistics-heavy** (eSewa Kendras, Constitution Bench judgments, committee size). Learn headline numbers like Supreme Court strength.
- **Laws are asked by number or by purpose** (127th Amendment, a department renamed). Section 4 lists the new laws and amendments.
- Papers drew on the previous 12–18 months, so the 2026 elections and 2025–26 appointments are the top tier.

1. Elections 2025–26 and new governments

1A. Assembly elections, April–May 2026 (results declared 4 May 2026)

State / UT	Result	Chief Minister	Chk
West Bengal (294 seats)	**BJP won 207**, TMC 80 – ends TMC's 15-year rule; first BJP government in the state	**Suvendu Adhikari**, sworn in 9 May 2026 at Brigade Parade Ground, Kolkata (Governor R. N. Ravi). He beat Mamata Banerjee in Bhabanipur by 15,105 votes. First cabinet: Dilip Ghosh, Agnimitra Paul, Ashok Kirtania, Nisith Pramanik, Kshudiram Tudu	✔
Tamil Nadu (234 seats; majority 118)	**TVK** (Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam) became the largest party with 108 seats, short of a majority; DMK finished third	**C. Joseph Vijay** (actor-turned-politician), sworn in 10 May 2026 after five Congress MLAs left the DMK-led alliance; backed by VCK, IUML, Left and an AIADMK rebel faction	✔
Kerala (140 seats; majority 71)	Congress-led **UDF won 102** (Congress 63), defeating the LDF after a decade in opposition	**V. D. Satheesan**, sworn in 18 May 2026 (Governor Rajendra Arlekar) with a 21-member cabinet; Ramesh Chennithala and IUML's P. K. Kunhalikutty are senior ministers	✔
Assam (126 seats)	**BJP** won a third consecutive term, with a majority on its own for the first time	**Himanta Biswa Sarma** continues as CM	✔
Puducherry (30 seats)	**AINRC–BJP (NDA) won 18 of 30**; record turnout of 89.87%	**N. Rangaswamy**, sworn in 13 May 2026 for the fifth time	✔

Note: Kerala is being renamed **Keralam**. The Kerala (Alteration of Name) Bill, 2026 was passed in the Monsoon Session (see Section 4), and official sources already say 'Keralam'. Three sitting CMs lost power in these polls (Mamata Banerjee, M. K. Stalin, Pinarayi Vijayan).

1B. Other recent elections

Election	Result	Chk
Bihar, Nov 2025 (243 seats)	**NDA won 202**: BJP 89, JD(U) 85, LJP (Ram Vilas) 19. **Nitish Kumar sworn in as CM for a record 10th time on 20 Nov 2025** at Gandhi Maidan, Patna (Governor Arif Mohammed Khan). Deputy CMs: **Samrat Choudhary** and **Vijay Kumar Sinha**. A Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls preceded the polls	✔
Delhi, Feb 2025	BJP won; **Rekha Gupta** became Chief Minister	◆
Manipur	President's rule ended; **Yumnam Khemchand Singh** sworn in as CM on 2 Feb 2026	✔
Upcoming (due 2027)	Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, Uttarakhand, Goa, Manipur, Gujarat and Himachal Pradesh assembly elections; Census 2027	◆

Static: Lok Sabha 2024 – 18th Lok Sabha, Modi sworn in for a third term on 9 June 2024 (second PM after Nehru to win three consecutive terms). SIR is an Election Commission exercise to clean the electoral rolls, first done in Bihar in 2025 and then extended to most states.

2. Top constitutional and national office-holders

Office	Present holder	Notes	Chk
President	**Droupadi Murmu**	15th President; in office since 25 July 2022	✔
Vice President	**C. P. Radhakrishnan**	15th VP; elected Sept 2025 after **Jagdeep Dhankhar resigned on 21 July 2025**; ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha	✔
Prime Minister	**Narendra Modi**	Third term since 9 June 2024	✔
Chief Justice of India	**Surya Kant** (53rd)	Took office 24 Nov 2025; retires 9 Feb 2027. Predecessor B. R. Gavai	✔
Lok Sabha Speaker	**Om Birla**	Since 19 June 2019; **Deputy Speaker post is vacant**. LoP: **Rahul Gandhi**	✔
Rajya Sabha	Chairman: VP Radhakrishnan	Deputy Chairman **Harivansh Narayan Singh**; LoP **Mallikarjun Kharge**; Leader of the House J. P. Nadda	✔
Chief Election Commissioner	**Gyanesh Kumar** (26th)	Since 19 Feb 2025; Election Commissioners Vivek Joshi and Sukhbir Singh Sandhu	✔
CAG	**K. Sanjay Murthy**		✔
Attorney General / Solicitor General	**R. Venkataramani** (16th AG) / **Tushar Mehta**	Venkataramani is your 2024 PYQ answer	✔

Office	Present holder	Notes	Chk
Chief Information Commissioner	**Heeralal Samariya**		✔
Central Vigilance Commission	**A. S. Rajeev**	Since Aug 2026	✔
UGC Chairperson	**Deepti Gaur Mukherjee**	Since 12 July 2026	✔
RBI Governor	**Sanjay Malhotra**	Since 11 Dec 2024	✔
Chief of Defence Staff	**Gen. N. Raja Subramani**	Took charge 31 May 2026 (succeeding Gen. Anil Chauhan)	✔
Army / Navy chiefs	**Gen. Dhiraj Seth** (Army, 30 June 2026) · **Adm. Krishna Swaminathan** (Navy, 1 June 2026)	Air Chief Marshal A. P. Singh (Air Force) ◆	✔
Union ministers	Home: Amit Shah · Defence: Rajnath Singh · Finance: Nirmala Sitharaman · External Affairs: S. Jaishankar ◆ · **Parliamentary Affairs: Kiren Rijiju** ✔ · Law: Arjun Ram Meghwal ✔	Pralhad Joshi (your 2023 PYQ answer) no longer holds Parliamentary Affairs	✔
Party presidents	BJP: **Nitin Nabin** (succeeded J. P. Nadda) · Congress: **Mallikarjun Kharge**		✔

3. Chief Ministers, Governors and Odisha

State	Chief Minister	Chk
Odisha	**Mohan Charan Majhi** (BJP; 15th CM; sworn in 11 June 2024)	✔
West Bengal · Tamil Nadu · Keralam · Assam · Puducherry	Suvendu Adhikari · C. Joseph Vijay · V. D. Satheesan · Himanta Biswa Sarma · N. Rangaswamy	✔
Bihar · Delhi · Manipur	Nitish Kumar · Rekha Gupta · Yumnam Khemchand Singh	✔
Maharashtra · Uttar Pradesh · Andhra Pradesh · Madhya Pradesh	Devendra Fadnavis · Yogi Adityanath · N. Chandrababu Naidu · Mohan Yadav	✔
Telangana · Karnataka · Himachal Pradesh	**A. Revanth Reddy** (your 2024 PYQ) · Siddaramaiah · Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu	✔
Others	Gujarat Bhupendra Patel · Rajasthan Bhajan Lal Sharma · Haryana Nayab Singh Saini · Punjab Bhagwant Mann · J&K Omar Abdullah · Jharkhand Hemant Soren · Chhattisgarh Vishnu Deo Sai · Goa Pramod Sawant · Uttarakhand Pushkar Singh Dhami	◆

Governors: the October 2026 changes

Appointed 12 Oct 2026	New post	Chk
Braj Mohan Ram (three-time former BJP MP, Jharkhand)	**Governor of Odisha**, succeeding Hari Babu Kambhampati	✔
Om Prakash Mathur	Governor of Keralam	✔
Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar	Governor of Tamil Nadu (earlier Governor of Kerala)	✔
Dr Sudha Yadav · Dhal Singh Bisen · Dushyant Gautam	Governors of Karnataka · Uttarakhand · Sikkim	✔
R. N. Ravi	Governor of West Bengal (administered oath to Adhikari, May 2026)	✔

Odisha box (Odisha appeared twice in the 2019 paper)

Item	Detail	Chk
Government	BJP won 79 of 147 seats in 2024 and ended Naveen Patnaik's BJD rule (BJD was the ruling party in 2018, as in your 2019 PYQ). **CM Mohan Charan Majhi**; Deputy CMs **K. V. Singh Deo** and **Pravati Parida**; Speaker **Surama Padhy**; Deputy Speaker Bhabani Shankar Bhoi; Leader of Opposition **Naveen Patnaik**	✔
Governor	Hari Babu Kambhampati (27th Governor, took oath 3 Jan 2025 after Raghubar Das resigned) is being replaced by **Braj Mohan Ram** (announced 12 Oct 2026)	✔
Budget	Odisha Budget 2026-27 was presented by CM Majhi (who holds Finance) on 20 Feb 2026; theme 'Samruddha Odisha by 2036'	✔
PYQ logic	In 2019 Odisha held assembly and Lok Sabha polls together; the state's election was in April–May (phase 2 of LS 2019 was on 18 April)	

Raj Bhavans have been renamed **Lok Bhavans** – the Odisha CM's office now posts 'Lok Bhawan' in 2026. Treat this as likely but cross-check the date of the change ◆.

4. Parliament, new laws and Constitution amendments

Item	Facts	Chk
Monsoon Session 2026	20 July – 13 Aug 2026: 19 sittings over 25 days; **12 Bills passed**; Lok Sabha productivity about 19%, Rajya Sabha about 39%. Disrupted by protests over the **NEET-UG 2026 paper leak** (the 3 May exam was cancelled and a CBI case filed) and Ram temple donation allegations. Speaker Om Birla skipped the usual valedictory address	✔
Bills passed	Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill · Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Bill (offence to disrupt Vande Mataram) · **Tribunals Reforms Bill** (creates a National Tribunals Commission) · Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) · NCDC (Amendment) · **Kerala (Alteration of Name) Bill** (Kerala becomes Keralam) · Registration of Births and Deaths (Amendment) · Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment · Income-Tax (Amendment) · Mines and Minerals (Amendment)	✔
Referred to committee	**Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026** sent to a Joint Parliamentary Committee. A panel's report on allegations against **Justice Yashwant Varma** was tabled; impeachment may follow in the Winter Session	✔
Budget Session 2026	13 government Bills introduced, 9 passed. Union Budget 2026-27 presented by Nirmala Sitharaman	✔
Women's reservation	106th Amendment (**Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam**, 2023): one-third seats for women in Lok Sabha and assemblies; it came into force on 16 April 2026, but the quota applies only after delimitation following the next Census (Article 334A)	✔
131st Amendment Bill 2026	Introduced 16 April 2026 with the Delimitation Bill and the UT Laws Bill: would raise Lok Sabha seats from 543 to 850 and allow delimitation on the 2011 Census so that the quota applies by 2029. **The Lok Sabha failed to pass it**; the allied Bills were withdrawn	✔
130th Amendment Bill	Proposes that a PM, CM or minister in custody for 30 consecutive days automatically loses office; examined by a Joint Parliamentary Committee	✔
One Nation, One Election	129th Amendment Bill (2024) with the UT Laws Bill: JPC (chair P. P. Chaudhary) got an extension to the Monsoon Session 2026; I found no report of passage	✔
2025 laws (from memory)	Waqf (Amendment) Act 2025 (renamed UMEED) · new Income-Tax Act 2025 (effective 1 Apr 2026) · four Labour Codes brought into force (Nov 2025) · Online Gaming Act 2025 · VB-G RAM G Act replacing MGNREGA (Dec 2025)	◆
PYQ link	Your PYQs asked about the 127th Amendment Bill 2021 (states' OBC lists) and the renaming of a department (DPIIT, 2019). Expect similar questions on the Kerala renaming and the Tribunals Reforms Bill	

5. Judiciary and the Election Commission

Item	Facts	Chk
Supreme Court strength	**Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Act, 2026** raised sanctioned strength from **34 to 38** (including the CJI; 33→37 excluding). Ordinance promulgated 16 May 2026 under Article 123; assent 11 Aug 2026. CJI Surya Kant wrote to the PM on 11 May. First increase since 2019 (30→33). Earlier steps: 8 judges (1950), 11 (1956), 14 (1960), 18 (1978), 26 (1986), 31 (2009). Over 92,000 cases were pending on 1 Jan 2026	✔
New judges	Justices Sunita Agarwal, Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya and Aparesh Kumar Singh took oath, bringing working strength to 37 (three women judges)	✔
CJI	Surya Kant, 53rd CJI from 24 Nov 2025 to 9 Feb 2027; Gavai recommended him as successor	✔
PYQ link (2022)	Supreme Court formed a **five-member committee** to probe the PM's Punjab security breach (Jan 2022); headed by Justice Indu Malhotra ◆	
PYQ link (2023)	689 eSewa Kendras in district courts (31 Dec 2022); 3 Constitution Bench judgments in Jan 2023; Supreme Court Mobile App 2.0 launched Dec 2022 by the CJI	
Election Commission	CEC Gyanesh Kumar (since 19 Feb 2025). The Commission ran the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls (Bihar 2025, then most states) and the 2026 assembly polls in five states	✔

6. 'Then and now' appointments tracker

Your PYQs asked about office-holders at a specific past date. These answers stay correct for that date, but the present holder is different for many posts.

Post	PYQ answer (date)	Present holder	Chk
Union Minister of Parliamentary Affairs	Pralhad Joshi (Jan 2023)	Kiren Rijiju	✔
Attorney General	R. Venkataramani (Oct 2022)	R. Venkataramani (unchanged)	✔
Vice Chief of Air Staff / Air Chief	A. P. Singh (Vice Chief, Feb 2023)	A. P. Singh became Air Chief Marshal (Sept 2024) ◆	◆
Vice Chief → Chief of Army Staff	Lt Gen Manoj Pande (Vice Chief, Jan 2022)	Gen. Dhiraj Seth (Army Chief since 30 June 2026)	✔
Chief of Defence Staff	Gen. Anil Chauhan	Gen. N. Raja Subramani (31 May 2026)	✔
Chief Election Commissioner	Rajiv Kumar	Gyanesh Kumar (26th)	✔
Chief Justice of India	D. Y. Chandrachud (2022–24)	Surya Kant (53rd)	✔
Vice President	Jagdeep Dhankhar (2022–25)	C. P. Radhakrishnan	✔
Chief Minister of Telangana	A. Revanth Reddy (Dec 2023, second CM)	A. Revanth Reddy (unchanged)	✔
Odisha Governor	Raghubar Das → Hari Babu Kambhampati	Braj Mohan Ram (from Oct 2026)	✔
UPSC Chairman	Arvind Saxena (Dec 2018)	Preeti Sudan ◆	◆
DRDO Chairman	G. Satheesh Reddy (2019)	Dr Samir V. Kamat ◆	◆
Deputy NSA	Pankaj Kumar Singh (Jan 2023)	Not checked – verify	

Rule of thumb for exam day: if a question says 'as of [past date]', answer with the holder at that date; if it says 'currently' or gives no date, use the present holder.

7. Practice MCQs (25)

Answers are on the last page. Each question uses facts marked ✔ above.

1. How many seats did the BJP win in the 2026 West Bengal assembly election?
(A) 177 (B) 195 (C) 207 (D) 220

2. First BJP Chief Minister of West Bengal:
(A) Dilip Ghosh (B) Suvendu Adhikari (C) Sukanta Majumdar (D) Samik Bhattacharya

3. Which party emerged as the largest in Tamil Nadu in 2026?
(A) DMK (B) AIADMK (C) BJP (D) TVK

4. Who became Chief Minister of Keralam in May 2026?
(A) V. D. Satheesan (B) Ramesh Chennithala (C) K. Muraleedharan (D) Pinarayi Vijayan

5. How many seats did the UDF win in the 140-member Kerala Assembly?
(A) 92 (B) 102 (C) 112 (D) 85

6. Puducherry Chief Minister sworn in on 13 May 2026:
(A) V. Narayanasamy (B) A. Namassivayam (C) N. Rangaswamy (D) K. Lakshminarayanan

7. How many seats did the NDA win in the Bihar election of Nov 2025?
(A) 174 (B) 188 (C) 210 (D) 202

8. Nitish Kumar took oath as Bihar CM for the ____ time on 20 Nov 2025:
(A) 10th (B) 9th (C) 8th (D) 11th

9. Who is the present Vice President of India?
(A) Jagdeep Dhankhar (B) C. P. Radhakrishnan (C) M. Venkaiah Naidu (D) Hamid Ansari

10. Present Chief Justice of India:
(A) B. R. Gavai (B) D. Y. Chandrachud (C) Surya Kant (D) Sanjiv Khanna

11. Present Chief Election Commissioner:
(A) Rajiv Kumar (B) Sushil Chandra (C) Sukhbir Sandhu (D) Gyanesh Kumar

12. Present CAG of India:
(A) K. Sanjay Murthy (B) Girish Chandra Murmu (C) Rajiv Mehrishi (D) Vinod Rai

13. Chief of Defence Staff from 31 May 2026:
(A) Gen. Anil Chauhan (B) Gen. N. Raja Subramani (C) Gen. Dhiraj Seth (D) Adm. Krishna Swaminathan

14. Chief of the Army Staff since 30 June 2026:
(A) Gen. Upendra Dwivedi (B) Gen. Manoj Pande (C) Gen. Dhiraj Seth (D) Gen. Bipin Rawat

15. Union Minister of Parliamentary Affairs (2026):
(A) Pralhad Joshi (B) Piyush Goyal (C) Arjun Ram Meghwal (D) Kiren Rijiju

16. BJP's national president (2026):
(A) Nitin Nabin (B) J. P. Nadda (C) Amit Shah (D) Bhupender Yadav

17. The sanctioned strength of the Supreme Court (including the CJI) is now:
(A) 34 (B) 38 (C) 33 (D) 42

18. The Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill 2026 aimed to:
(A) Abolish the Rajya Sabha (B) Create a new High Court (C) Raise Lok Sabha seats to 850 and enable delimitation for women's quota (D) Change the retirement age of judges

19. What happened to the 131st Amendment Bill in the Lok Sabha?
(A) Passed unanimously (B) Passed with a joint sitting (C) Sent to a JPC (D) It failed to pass

20. Which Bill renames Kerala as Keralam?
(A) Kerala (Alteration of Name) Bill, 2026 (B) States Reorganisation (Amendment) Bill (C) Constitution (130th Amendment) Bill (D) Tribunals Reforms Bill

21. How many Bills were passed by both Houses in the Monsoon Session 2026?
(A) 8 (B) 12 (C) 15 (D) 19

22. Chief Minister of Odisha:
(A) Naveen Patnaik (B) Manmohan Samal (C) Mohan Charan Majhi (D) K. V. Singh Deo

23. Governor of Odisha appointed on 12 October 2026:
(A) Hari Babu Kambhampati (B) Raghubar Das (C) Ganeshi Lal (D) Braj Mohan Ram

24. Who became Manipur's CM on 2 Feb 2026 after President's rule?
(A) Yumnam Khemchand Singh (B) N. Biren Singh (C) Okram Ibobi Singh (D) Thokchom Radheshyam

25. The Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam came into force on:
(A) 26 Jan 2024 (B) 16 April 2026 (C) 9 Sept 2023 (D) 1 Jan 2025

Answer key

1-C **2**-B **3**-D **4**-A **5**-B **6**-C **7**-D **8**-A **9**-B **10**-C **11**-D **12**-A **13**-B **14**-C **15**-D **16**-A **17**-B **18**-C **19**-D **20**-A **21**-B **22**-C **23**-D **24**-A **25**-B

Before you rely on this: items marked ◆ need one cross-check, especially the Union ministers other than Rijiju and Meghwal (I did not find a 2026 reshuffle either way), the Air Chief, UPSC and DRDO chiefs, and the Deputy NSA. Reply '**next**' for the next part (International affairs, summits, treaties and defence exercises).